

VACATIONS AND THE CARBON FOOTPRINT

Key Words and Phrases • LEVEL B

The words and phrases below appear in the article *Vacations and the Carbon Footprint*. Study the table carefully, then complete the gap-fill exercise in Part 2.

PART 1 – VOCABULARY TABLE

WORD / PHRASE	DEFINITION	EXAMPLE SENTENCE
generates	produces or creates something, especially energy or waste	<i>A return flight from London to New York generates over seven tonnes of CO₂.</i>
long-haul	relating to a flight or journey that covers a very long distance	<i>Long-haul flights produce significantly more emissions than short-haul ones.</i>
shutdowns	periods when a service or activity is stopped, often unexpectedly	<i>Tourism fell sharply during the COVID-19 shutdowns of 2020 and 2021.</i>
aloft	in the air; flying at height	<i>At any given time, there are nearly 10,000 aircraft aloft around the world.</i>
aboard	on or in a plane, ship, or other form of transport	<i>There are over 1.2 million passengers aboard commercial aircraft at any given moment.</i>
commercial	related to the buying and selling of goods or services, often for profit	<i>Commercial flights are one of the fastest-growing sources of CO₂ emissions globally.</i>
unsustainable burden	a level of pressure or harm that cannot continue without causing serious damage	<i>The rise in aviation emissions represents an unsustainable burden on the planet's climate.</i>
residual	a leftover or waste product from an industrial or chemical process	<i>Cruise ships run on heavy fuel oil, a toxic residual of the petrol industry.</i>
disposable	designed to be used once and then thrown away	<i>Cruise ships have been fined for dumping disposable plastics and food waste into the ocean.</i>
expelled	forced or pushed out of a place	<i>Crew members were found to have deliberately expelled sewage and waste into the sea.</i>
conscience	the inner feeling that tells you whether your actions are right or wrong	<i>Carbon offsets allow travellers to ease their conscience without actually flying less.</i>
carbon offset	a scheme that compensates for CO ₂ emissions by funding environmental projects	<i>Buying a carbon offset redirects money towards tree-planting and renewable energy projects.</i>
carbon footprint	the total amount of CO ₂ produced directly or indirectly by a person or activity	<i>The carbon footprint of a return long-haul flight can be several tonnes of CO₂.</i>

WORD / PHRASE	DEFINITION	EXAMPLE SENTENCE
emissions	gases released into the atmosphere, especially those causing climate change	<i>Tourism accounts for around five percent of total global CO₂ emissions each year.</i>
budget-conscious	careful about spending money; trying to keep costs low	<i>Budget-conscious travellers often choose cheap flights over slower, greener alternatives.</i>
embarkation	the process of boarding a ship or aircraft at the start of a journey	<i>Most cruise passengers fly to their port of embarkation, adding aviation emissions before boarding.</i>
ecological	relating to the relationship between living things and their environment	<i>Reducing our ecological footprint means making more responsible choices about how we travel.</i>
staycation	a holiday spent at home or in your local area rather than travelling abroad	<i>A staycation is the most carbon-friendly holiday option available to most people.</i>
sustainable	able to continue without causing lasting damage to the environment	<i>Sustainable travel means choosing low-emission transport and eco-friendly accommodation.</i>

PART 2 – GAP-FILL EXERCISE

Complete the sentences using the correct word or phrase from the word bank below. You may need to change the form of the word. Some sentences require more than one answer.

WORD BANK

generates	long-haul	shutdowns	aloft
aboard	commercial	unsustainable burden	residual
disposable	expelled	conscience	carbon offset
carbon footprint	emissions	budget-conscious	embarkation
ecological	staycation	sustainable	

1	A long-haul flight from Houston to London _____ approximately seven tonnes of CO ₂ — a significant _____ on the planet's climate.
2	At any given moment, nearly 10,000 aircraft are _____ worldwide, with over a million passengers _____.
3	Global CO ₂ _____ from _____ flights are rising 70% faster than the UN predicted, representing an _____ on the environment.
4	Cruise ships run on heavy fuel oil — a toxic _____ of the petrol industry — and have been caught _____ sewage and _____ plastics into the ocean.
5	Many travellers ease their _____ by purchasing a _____, which directs money to environmental projects to compensate for their _____.

6	The _____ traveller might prefer a cheap flight over a train ticket, but the _____ impact of flying is far greater.
7	Most cruise passengers fly to their port of _____, adding further aviation _____ before they even board the ship.
8	A _____ is the most _____ holiday option — exploring your local area produces almost no CO ₂ at all.
9	Choosing ground transport over air travel is one of the most effective ways to reduce your personal _____ and live more _____.

Write your answers here:

1. _____	2. _____	3. _____
4. _____	5. _____	6. _____
7. _____	8. _____	9. _____